

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 13

Reviewing Overall Progress & Deepening Long-Term Maintenance

Fictional Educational Example — Full Detailed

SESSION INFORMATION

Client: RK (35 y/o Male)
Session #: 13 of 16

Therapist: Dr. A.
Focus: Overall progress review + Long-term maintenance

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client continues to show strong, consistent progress. Belief in the old perfectionistic thought remains low (~20%). He has been actively using his Maintenance Plan and Coping Card. Today we will do a comprehensive review of overall progress since Session 1, review recent experiments, deepen long-term maintenance strategies, and prepare for the final three sessions with increased focus on independence.

SESSION START & PROGRESS REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, RK. We're now at Session 13 — only three sessions left in the main course. Before we go further, let's take a big-picture look at how far you've come since we started.

Client: It feels like a completely different person compared to when I first walked in. My GAD-7 was 18 and now it's around 6-7. I sleep much better, I'm not constantly worried, and I actually enjoy work again instead of dreading it.

Therapist: That's a huge transformation. What changes feel the most meaningful to you personally?

Client: Two things stand out the most: First, I no longer feel like I have to be perfect to be competent. Second, I'm much more present with my wife — we're actually talking and spending time together instead of me being mentally checked out or irritable.

Therapist: Those are wonderful changes. The fact that both your work life and your relationship have improved shows how interconnected everything is.

DEEPENING LONG-TERM MAINTENANCE

Therapist: As we get closer to the end, I want to make sure you feel fully equipped for the long term. Let's talk about how you will keep these gains alive months and even years from now.

Client: I've been thinking about that too. I don't want to go back to how I was before.

Therapist: One powerful way to maintain progress is to keep doing small "maintenance experiments" even after therapy ends. For example, once a month, deliberately do something that used to trigger your old fear (like sharing an idea without over-preparing) just to keep the new learning fresh.

Client: That makes sense. Like keeping the muscle strong even after the main training is over.

Therapist: Exactly. We can also schedule your booster sessions as "check-ins" where we review how the Maintenance Plan is working and adjust anything if needed.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue daily diary + Worry Time / Postponement
2. Practice using your Maintenance Plan and Coping Card
3. Do one "maintenance experiment" this week (something that used to be difficult but now feels manageable)
4. Write down 3 things you will commit to doing regularly after therapy ends to keep your gains strong

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we took a big-picture look at your progress and started thinking about long-term maintenance. You've come a very long way. How does it feel to hear that reflected back?

Client: It feels really good. Sometimes I forget how bad it was before because things feel normal now. It's nice to be reminded of how much has changed.

Therapist: That's a very good sign — it means the new ways of thinking and behaving have become your new normal. Any questions?

Client: No, I'm clear.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client demonstrating excellent insight and ownership of his progress.
- Strong motivation for long-term maintenance.
- Belief in old core thought remains low and stable.
- Next session: Review long-term commitments, continue experiments, deepen relapse prevention, prepare for final two sessions (14 & 15) and termination (Session 16).

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.